Recreation and Sport Policy

The Green Party will ensure equitable access to recreational and sporting facilities and, through public funding, ensure that cost is not a barrier to participation in recreation and sport in our communities. We will regulate harmful forms of recreation and sport, including gambling.

Vision

Recreation and sport contribute to the mental and physical health, active lifestyles, and social wellbeing of all.

Values and Principles

Decisions relating to recreation and sport must uphold the following values and principles:

- *Honour Te Tiriti o Waitangi*: Sports and the art of playing and recreation have been core parts of Māori society for over a thousand years so tākaro Māori should be recognised and supported.
- *Ecological Wisdom*: Communities need access to the natural environment and public open space for a range of recreational opportunities, whilst ensuring sensitive ecological habitats are protected.
- *Social Responsibility*: Recreational and sporting activities should be accessible to all, regardless of age, gender, ethnicity or disability, and should be equitably resourced.
- *Appropriate Decision-Making*: Community-led recreation and sport should be prioritised. Communities should be supported to make ecologically and socially robust decisions on recreational and sporting facilities and activities.
- *Non-Violence*: Recreation and sport should be provided and supported in a way that supports wellbeing and avoids harm.
- *Regulation*: Public policy should operate to reduce the harm caused by gambling and to protect our communities and public services from gambling harm. The most harmful forms of gambling should be regulated.

Strategic Priorities

The Green Party's strategic goals include:

> *"We strive to create a more connected, compassionate and equal Aotearoa (where) decision-making about resource use will provide for community participation."*

Actions in this policy that will help achieve this include:

- Provide sporting and recreational facilities, services, and activities that are designed and developed to meet the diverse needs of local communities, now and into the future, and reflect the people who live there. (1.1.1)

- Remove all barriers that discourage and prevent Rainbow people, especially those who are trans, non-binary and intersex, from participating and competing in sports. (1.5.1)
- Ensure the primary focus of gambling legislation is the elimination of gambling harm. (2.1.1)

Connected Policies

Through the environmental impact of recreation and sport and its dependence on the natural world, this policy is connected to our Biodiversity and Environmental Regeneration and Tourism Policies. Gambling is connected to Animal Welfare and, through funding of community organisations from gambling proceeds, to our Community in the Economy Policy.

Policy Positions

1. Equity in Recreation and Sport

Issues

Not all communities, or groups within communities, have equal access to recreational and sporting opportunities as part of a healthy lifestyle. This is an issue at all levels, from inequitable support for men's and women's professional sports to inequitable facilities outside of main urban centres.

Actions

1.1. Provide sporting and recreational facilities, services, and activities that are designed and developed to:

1.1.1. Meet the diverse needs of local communities, now and into the future, and reflect the people who live there;

1.1.2. Provide a focal point for communities, to help build connection and a sense of belonging across ages and cultures;

1.1.3. Cater for a range of abilities, interests, and schedules;

1.1.4. Enable the participation of marginalised groups, specifically, including women, young families, disabled people, and seniors;

1.1.5. Be easily accessed by walking, cycling, and public transport;

1.1.6. Minimise conflicts between different user groups;

1.1.7. Maximise use of the venue and minimise the costs for individual and group activities (e.g. flexible pricing); and

1.1.8. Avoid damage to sensitive ecosystems, including using 'green' building design and products.

1.2. Provide adequate funding to:

1.2.1. Develop and maintain recreational and sporting facilities, services, and activities;

1.2.2. Enable schools, community trusts, Māori organisations, and other relevant groups, to provide recreational and sporting facilities and activities;

1.2.3. Minimise financial barriers to participation;

1.2.4. Facilitate pathways to excellence for people with potential to perform nationally or internationally;

1.2.5. Support the contribution of volunteers, coaches, officials and administrators to recreational and sporting activities;

1.2.6. Support the promotion and profiling of a range of recreational and sporting activities to encourage participation, healthy lifestyles, and a highly ethical approach to sporting behaviour; and

1.2.7. Fill the funding gap left by any ban on sponsorship that advertises products or activities that are strongly linked to broad social and/or environmental risks.

1.3. Expand the responsibilities of the Minister of Sport and Recreation to include coordinating relevant funding, education, and health and safety provisions.

1.4. Support flaxroots-level sports by:

1.4.1. Preventing funding of elite and premier-grade activities and facilities from negatively impacting community activities and infrastructure; and

1.4.2. Providing training and support for coaches, volunteers, officials and administrators.

1.5. Support equity in sports and recreation by:

1.5.1. Removing all barriers that discourage and prevent Rainbow people, especially those who are trans, non-binary and intersex, from participating and competing in sports;

1.5.2. Working with national sporting bodies to reduce ableism and increase access for disabled people to sport and recreational activities; and

1.5.3. Facilitating equitable access to high-performance sporting opportunities and high-performance development pathways.

1.6. Support outdoor active recreation by:

1.6.1. Protecting land for recreation and sporting purposes;

1.6.2. Providing adult playgrounds and outdoor gyms around retirement villages, papakāinga, and parks;

1.6.3. Developing safe recreational walking and cycling infrastructure throughout Aotearoa New Zealand;

1.6.4. Providing off-road tracks that enable a range of outdoor recreational activities, give access to parks, bush, and waterways, and/or connect communities;

1.6.5. Enabling access to a range of outdoor watersports and water-based activities; and

1.6.6. Promoting the key role played by regional and national parks, beaches and rivers, and local parks and reserves in the provision of recreational activities.

1.7. Minimise harm to animals from recreation and sport by:

1.7.1. Prohibiting recreational and sporting activities that cause unnecessary distress or pain to animals or normalise cruelty, including rodeo and horse racing.

2. Gambling

Issues

Machine-based and remote gambling causes significant harm to individuals, whanau, communities, and animals. Personal harms include physical and mental ill-health, crime, dependence, and financial, employment, and relationship problems; harms ripple out to families, friends and workplaces. Māori and Pasifika are particularly impacted.

Actions

2.1. Amend relevant legislation to:

2.1.1. Ensure the primary focus of gambling legislation is the elimination of gambling harm;

2.1.2. Ensure gambling policy decisions are based on robust evidence;

2.1.3. Enable communities to make decisions about gambling;

2.1.4. Continue to allow forms of gambling that research shows cause little harm;

2.1.5. Prevent new forms of gambling that are associated with harm; and

2.1.6. Regulate all existing forms of gambling to prevent or minimise harm.

2.2. Disestablish the role of Minister for Racing and place responsibility for all forms of gambling with the Minister of Internal Affairs.

2.3. Ensure that gambling representatives and bodies that rely on funding from gambling cannot unduly influence decisions about regulation of gambling harm.

2.4. Enable informed decision-making about gambling by:

2.4.1. Conducting a full social, economic and environmental impact study on the outcomes of gambling in Aotearoa New Zealand;

2.4.2. Conducting ongoing research to evaluate harm elimination strategies, with particular emphasis on strategies by and for Māori and Pasifika communities; and

2.4.3. Requiring all current gambling forms that use animals to make publicly available the numbers of animals bred, raced, injured, euthanised and re-homed or retired.

2.5. Before the introduction of substantially new forms of gambling into Aotearoa New Zealand, or significant amendments to existing forms of gambling:

2.5.1. Ensure the potential impacts are comprehensively researched and understood; and

2.5.2. Require a legislated amendment to the Gambling Act.

2.6. Facilitate the speedy adoption of gambling harm minimisation measures, with an emphasis on pre-harm prevention and public health approaches, including by:

2.6.1. Proactively implementing strategies to raise awareness in vulnerable communities about the risks of gambling harm.

2.7. Minimise harm from high-risk gambling, by:

2.7.1. Supporting a moratorium on issuing any new casino venue licences in Aotearoa New Zealand;

2.7.2. Supporting the right of the local community to vote in a binding referendum on the future of existing casinos when their venue licences come up for renewal; and

2.7.3. Phasing out licensing of non-casino gambling machines (i.e. pokies), while filling resulting funding gaps for community organisations.

2.8. Amend the regulations for distributing gambling proceeds by:

2.8.1. Prohibiting political parties from benefiting from the profits of the most addictive forms of gambling, including gambling machines and casinos; and

2.8.2. Limit the distribution of gambling proceeds to racing organisations.

2.9. Minimise the harmful impacts of advertising gambling by:

2.9.1. Reviewing gambling advertising standards, particularly in terms of their impact on children;

2.9.2. Establishing a fund from the gambling levy to match all gambling advertising with gambling harm prevention public health messages; and

2.9.3. Prohibit the advertising and promotion of harmful forms of gambling and gambling products.